

Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	
Team ID	
Project Name	Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes. It is a useful tool that helps teams better understand their users.

For the Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow project, the exercise was used to step into the shoes of the people most affected by today's manual network change process — the employee raising the request and the network administrator fulfilling it — so the solution is designed around their real goals and frustrations, not just the technical workflow.

Empathy Map Canvas

Persona: Network Requester (Employee / IT Support Engineer) — Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow

The Empathy Map Canvas is a structured tool for understanding a user's experience. It consists of several colored sections: a yellow 'SAYS' section at the top, a light blue 'THINKS' section, a light green 'DOES' section, and a pink 'FEELS' section, all arranged around a central dark blue circle. The central circle is labeled 'Network Requester' and contains the text 'Wants speed, visibility & a clean audit trail'. Below these sections are two horizontal bars: a purple 'GOALS' bar and an orange 'PAINS' bar. Each section contains specific observations or insights related to the user's experience.

SAYS

- "Why does a simple VLAN or firewall request take days to get approved?"
- "I have no idea who is holding up my ticket right now."
- "I need this network access before my project deadline."
- "The request form asks for details I don't always have."

THINKS

- "There must be a faster, self-service way to raise this."
- "I hope this went to the right approver."
- "Will this change even be logged properly for audit?"
- "Why do I re-enter the same information every time?"

DOES

- Raises requests via e-mail, spreadsheets, or ad-hoc tickets
- Calls or messages the network team for status updates
- Manually cross-checks CMDB before submitting
- Chases approvers across multiple levels by hand

FEELS

- Frustrated by delays and lack of visibility
- Anxious about compliance and audit-readiness
- Relieved only after repeated manual follow-up
- Stressed when configuration errors surface later

GOALS

Get network changes (firewall, VLAN, VPN, IP allocation) approved and implemented quickly and accurately, with a complete, audit-ready trail — without manual coordination across teams.

PAINS

Delayed approvals, no real-time status visibility, inconsistent configuration tracking, manual audit preparation, and error-prone hand-offs between requester, approver, and network team.

Figure 1: Empathy Map Canvas — Network Requester persona, Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow